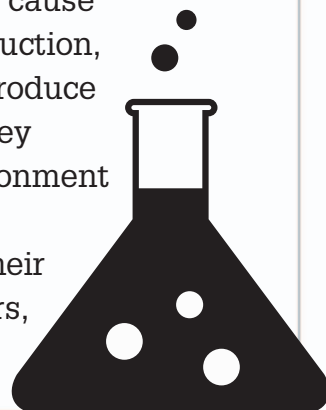




MICROBIOLOGIST

JOB DESCRIPTION

A microbiologist studies tiny organisms, such as bacteria and viruses, which can cause disease, pollution, and crop destruction, but which may also be used to produce vaccines to prevent diseases. They collect organisms from the environment or from patients, and study and conduct experiments on them. Their work benefits a number of sectors, from medicine to agriculture.



SALARY

Junior microbiologist ★★☆☆☆

Senior consultant ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

A fast-growing sector • Opportunities in research, production, quality control, and in government • Some research studies at the cutting edge of science

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Laboratory work • Health and medicine • Research and development • Food technology • Biology • Physics • Chemistry



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS A degree in microbiology or a related subject is required. Many employers require a PhD and academic research experience.



LIFESTYLE Most microbiologists work regular hours, but they may need to supervise laboratory experiments during evenings and weekends.



LOCATION Much of the work is laboratory-based, although experienced microbiologists may need to gather samples at a variety of locations.



THE REALITIES Laboratory work can be repetitive, especially for junior microbiologists. Competition for senior roles is intense.

CAREER PATHS

Qualified microbiologists can find jobs in many areas, including the health care, pharmaceutical, food, water, and agricultural industries. They will be expected to publish research papers to build their academic reputation and gain promotion.

LABORATORY TECHNICIAN

After leaving high school, you can start working as a laboratory technician, while studying for a degree part-time.



GRADUATE You will need a degree in life sciences, such as microbiology, applied biology, biomedical science, or molecular biology. A graduate-level degree will help you to progress to more responsible positions.

